# How to write an ARTICLE

## What is an article?

An article is a journalistic text meant to be published online or in a print medium (newspaper, magazine, book, ...).

**Aim**: inform, persuade, entertain, provoke a reaction, ...

**Target group**: the readers of the publication, online readers

**Register**: informal, neutral or formal (depending on task and readership)

## Structure and content:

Catchy Title:

- must be informative and attractive
- could be a rhetorical question (Why not...?), directly addressing the reader (Everything you have always wanted to know about...), with powerful adjectives (The bloody, brutal business of ...) a reference to a well-known idea (An ode to...,), provocative (Meet the People Getting Paid to Kill Our Planet)

Date and Writer's Name

Introduction:

- opening should be linked to the title
- introduces the topic and engages the reader (gripping)
- can start with a question, a quote, etc. which introduces the topic

Main Part:

- separate paragraphs for the main ideas (one paragraph for each content point)
- every paragraph should contain a topic sentence, explanation, examples
- paragraphs must be clearly linked
- the reader can relate to the content

Conclusion:

- rounds up the article
- can be provocative or humorous
- an open ending is also possible – leaves readers with a thought-provoking idea
- express your opinion if required

STYLE- Typical linguistic features of articles:

- rhetorical questions (interaction with reader)
- readers can be addressed directly (use of the pronoun "you")
- can be personal, light-hearted, conversational (depending on the task and readership)

## Useful phrases

| Introduction | Main Part |
|---|---|
| Have you ever asked yourself....? / Why not...? | How come...? |
| There is nothing better/worse than... | On top of that... |
| Don't you believe...? / Do you ever wonder...? | It is worth mentioning that... |
| Can you imagine living/ spending/ working...? | There is (no) reason to believe that... |
| Are you also fed up with/ angry at...? | There is no doubt that... |
| Are you one of those people/readers who...? | Let's take a look at... |

| | |
|---|---|
| What would you think if...? | Let's imagine.../ Imagine you are... |
| You have probably heard countless times that... | Let's face the truth. /Honestly, is it fair that...? |
| Main Part | Conclusion |
| Let's suppose ... | In short,... |
| Keeping in mind that... | To put this in a nutshell,... |
| Arguably,... | What it comes down to in the end is that... |
| As everyone can imagine,... | Whatever the future may hold... |
| It has been suggested by... | .... you will not regret it. |

**Article sample task**: Companion p 66

**Article sample task**: "Model task: Article" Textsorten. p.2. hpt Verlag.
<https://www.hpt.at/sites/default/files/fileadmin/documents/SchulbuchPlus/170022_SBP_Going_for_Finals_BHS/Textsorten_mit_Model_Task_for_BHS_2016.pdf>

In your local English café, "Shakespeare & Co.", you have seen an English magazine reaching out to its readers.

***"We are planning a series of articles on the effects of new technology on our lives. We would like you, the readers, to write us an article. The best article will win a brand-new iPad."***

You have decided to send in an article.



In your **article** you should:

- point out how important technology is in your job or school work
- comment on how the internet has affected your life
- argue if recent technological changes are for better or worse

Give your article a **title**. Write around **250 words**.

***Technology – a curse in disguise***

The technological revolution is full of paradoxes:

it has enabled us to communicate more easily, yet it is killing the art of conversation. It has supposedly freed up more time for leisure, yet it has caused us to become slaves to our work.

If I didn't have a mobile phone I wouldn't be able to respond to the demands of my job. My clients would abandon me and my boss would sack me. So, regrettably and much to the annoyance of my family, it is switched on 24 hours a day. I can spend whole weekends without saying a word to my husband or the children, either because I am on the phone or because they are too angry to want to speak to me.

My attitude to the computer is equally ambivalent.

Thanks to my laptop I can reply to clients' emails from the comfort of my hotel room almost as soon as I have received them. But the faster I work, the greater my clients' expectations become of me and consequently the more pressure I create for myself.

Even in the home environment the computer seems to create more problems than it resolves. My husband and I have now got into the dubious habit of doing our supermarket shopping on the Internet. This cuts us off from human contact and turns us into antisocial, overweight couch potatoes.

All of this leads me to the firm conclusion that mobile phones and computers should all carry a government health warning: technology can seriously damage your health and your personality.

Interesting title:
to attract readers' attention and engage their interest

Introduction:
strong **opening paragraph** to encourage readers to go on reading

BP 1: mobile phone
**D[i] 1:** effects on job
**D 2:** effects on family life

BP 2: the internet
**D 1:** effects on job
**D 2:** consequences

BP 3:
**D 1:** shopping
**D 2:** lack of human contact
**D 3:** lack of exercise

Conclusion:
leaving the reader something to think about

260 words

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